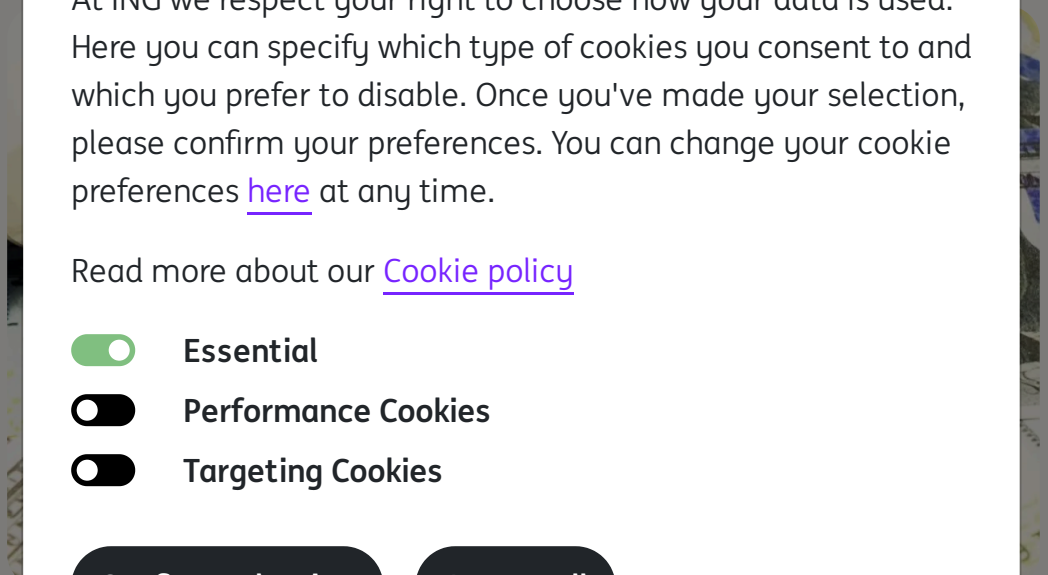
Rising fuel prices and the war with Iran have significantly increased the chances of a Democrat-controlled Congress. This could mean greater pricing pressure on pharma and more healthcare affordability measures. However, surprises do happen. We therefore assess three possible scenarios and what they mean for healthcare and pharma





Cookie settings

At ING we respect your right to choose how your data is used. Here you can specify which type of cookies you consent to and which you prefer to disable. Once you've made your selection, please confirm your preferences. You can change your cookie preferences here at any time.

Read more about our Cookie policy

- Essential
- Performance Cookies
- Targeting Cookies

Confirm selection

Accept all

The US midterm elections take place on 3 November. All 435 seats in the House of Representatives and 35 of the 100 Senate seats are up for election. With Trump's approval rating hitting a record low according to a Fox News poll, it is no wonder that the pollsters currently suggest the Democrats lead by around 8 percentage points nationally. A Democratic takeover of Congress therefore seems most likely, but a Democratic clean sweep is not certain.

We look at what the possible outcomes could mean for healthcare and pharma.

The key differences

Cookie settings

At ING we respect your right to choose how your data is used. Here you can specify which type of cookies you consent to and which you prefer to disable. Once you've made your selection, please confirm your preferences. You can change your cookie preferences here at any time.

Read more about our Cookie policy

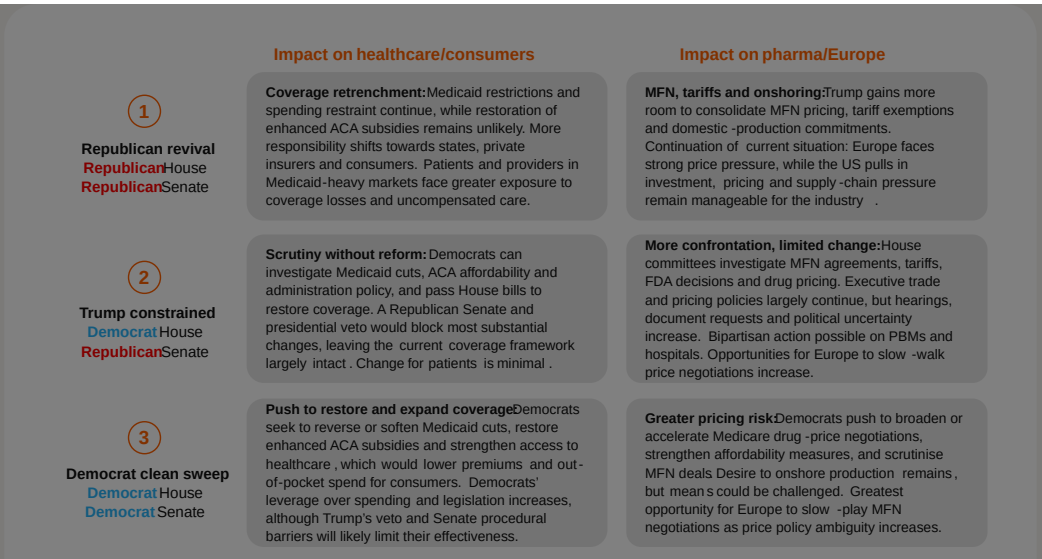
Essential

Performance Cookies

Targeting Cookies

the objectives are largely bipartisan.

Midterm election scenarios and their impact on US consumers and Europe as well as healthcare and pharma



Source: ING

Cookie settings

At ING we respect your right to choose how your data is used. Here you can specify which type of cookies you consent to and which you prefer to disable. Once you've made your selection, please confirm your preferences. You can change your cookie preferences here at any time.

Read more about our Cookie policy

Essential

Performance Cookies

Targeting Cookies

greater scope to embed MFN pricing and use tariff exemptions and company agreements to further secure US manufacturing commitments. Pharmaceutical companies would gain greater clarity about the direction of policy, but not relief from pricing or supply-chain pressure. In short, this would be the scenario with the greatest continuity in pharma policy.

Scenario 2: Trump constrained

A Democratic House could obstruct legislation, control committees and launch investigations. But bills restoring ACA subsidies or

mitigating Medicaid cuts would face a Republican Senate and, ultimately, Trump's veto. Healthcare policy would therefore become more confrontational but not necessarily very different in practice. Coverage losses and stricter Medicaid eligibility rules would remain immediate issues, while Democrats would use hearings and must-pass spending legislation to put pressure on the administration.

Pharma would face detailed scrutiny of MFN deals, tariffs, and the implementation of Medicare negotiations. Yet neither party would control all the levers required for sweeping reform. This could create room for narrower bipartisan measures, particularly around Pharmacy Benefit Managers (PBM) and hospitals. Broader reform w… e
U…

S…

C…
p…
h…
n…
f…
i…
f…

F…
d…
c…
w… negotiations agreed under the IRA, alongside greater scrutiny of launch prices and PBMs.

Moreover, stronger congressional protection of National Institutes of Health (NIH) funding, scientific institutions and Food and Drug Administration (FDA) review capacity would support biotech and early-stage innovation. If Democrats truly make drug-price negotiations a priority, then this scenario could lead to a mixed outcome: greater price pressure, but a stronger public research base and a better-funded FDA.

Cookie settings

At ING we respect your right to choose how your data is used. Here you can specify which type of cookies you consent to and which you prefer to disable. Once you've made your selection, please confirm your preferences. You can change your cookie preferences here at any time.

Read more about our Cookie policy

Essential

Performance Cookies

Targeting Cookies

Why a Democratic clean sweep would be good news for European governments

For Europe, pressure on the pharma industry to localise in the US will remain under all three scenarios. Democrats may criticise the means, but they also view pharmaceutical supply chains as a national-security issue. Republican and Democratic policy objectives therefore broadly align, while Trump retains substantial executive authority over trade.

The biggest difference is that a Democratic clean sweep would demand greater transparency around MFN deals and increase price p
t
n
r
p
i

E
a
t
c
r
p

Cookie settings

At ING we respect your right to choose how your data is used. Here you can specify which type of cookies you consent to and which you prefer to disable. Once you've made your selection, please confirm your preferences. You can change your cookie preferences here at any time.

Read more about our Cookie policy

Essential

Performance Cookies

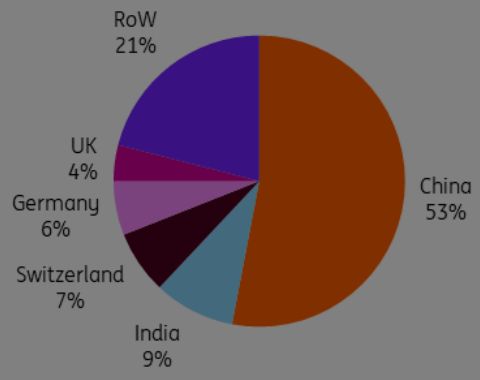
Targeting Cookies

E
c

China will also keep facing bipartisan pressure. Both parties now view pharma and biotech as key to national security interests and support greater domestic manufacturing and reduced foreign dependencies. However, China's dominance in active pharmaceutical ingredients is unlikely to wane any time soon.

The US imports more than half of its pharmaceuticals from China

US pharmaceutical imports (branded and generic) by volume in 2023



Source: United Nations Commodity Trade Statistics Database; BMI; ING

Furthermore, commercial demand for Chinese innovation will not d
r e
t
d e
n
h
a
a

T
R
c d
t
t
n

Cookie settings

At ING we respect your right to choose how your data is used. Here you can specify which type of cookies you consent to and which you prefer to disable. Once you've made your selection, please confirm your preferences. You can change your cookie preferences here at any time.

Read more about our Cookie policy

Essential

Performance Cookies

Targeting Cookies

US | Trump | Pharmaceuticals | Midterm elections | Healthcare | Elections

Content Disclaimer

This publication has been prepared by ING solely for information purposes irrespective of a particular user's means, financial situation or investment objectives. The information does not constitute investment recommendation, and nor is it investment, legal or tax advice or an offer or solicitation to purchase or sell any financial instrument.

Read more

Share Download

Cookie settings

At ING we respect your right to choose how your data is used. Here you can specify which type of cookies you consent to and which you prefer to disable. Once you've made your selection, please confirm your preferences. You can change your cookie preferences here at any time.

Read more about our Cookie policy

Essential

Performance Cookies

Targeting Cookies